Earnings Filings and Price Reactions: An Event Study of SEC 8-K Item 2.02 Announcements for US Mega-Caps

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[1]Hypothesis × Quant

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Abstract

Hypothesis: H_0: mean $|\mathrm{CAR}[0,+1]|$ on 8-K Item 2.02 filing days equals that of ordinary days; H_1: it is larger

Data: 1,318 Item 2.02 filings by 35 US mega-caps, 2017-10-24 to 2026-10-22, with EDGAR acceptance timestamps

Method: Market-model abnormal returns (S&P 500, estimation window $[-250,-31]$), reaction day set by the acceptance time in US/Eastern, 5,000-draw placebo over non-event sessions of the same stock

Results: Mean $|\mathrm{CAR}|$ 4.59% versus placebo 1.70% (one-sided $p = 0.0002$); signed mean CAR 0.059% ($t = 0.34$).

Research decision: ACCEPTED

1 Design

Events come from the SEC submissions API: Form 8-K filings whose items include 2.02. A filing accepted at or after 16:00 US/Eastern (or on a non-trading day) is assigned to the next session so that the measured reaction cannot precede the disclosure [MacKinlay, 1997]. The two-day CAR starts on that session. The placebo preserves each stock's own volatility regime.

2 Results

Table 1: Mean $|\mathrm{CAR}[0,+1]|$ of Item 2.02 filings by year

Year	Events	Mean $\lvert\mathrm{CAR}\rvert$
2017	24	4.67%
2018	145	4.71%
2019	146	3.98%
2020	145	4.54%
2021	142	3.74%
2022	148	4.98%
2023	150	4.41%
2024	149	5.01%
2025	145	4.53%
2026	124	5.46%

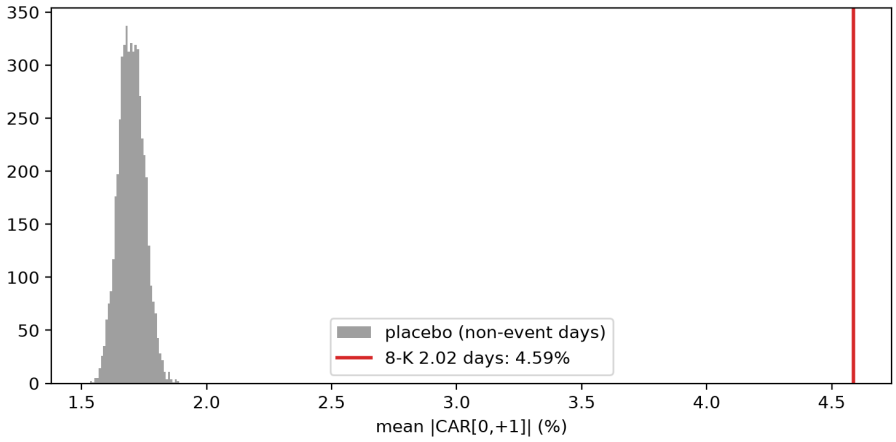


Figure 1: Observed mean absolute CAR against the placebo distribution.

3 Limitations

Filings accepted during trading hours include a pre-announcement part of the day, which understates the reaction. Earnings dates are not exogenous to volatility. The universe is today's mega-caps, so the results do not generalise to small or delisted firms. The signed CAR needs a surprise measure (consensus data is not free) and is reported only descriptively.

References

A Craig MacKinlay. Event studies in economics and finance. *Journal of Economic Literature*, 35 (1):13–39, 1997.